

Board of Library Trustees

Amanda Hirst
Library Director

Library IT Specialist
Kaden Casanave

Assistant Director
for Administration
Danielle Savin

Administrative Staff:
Administrative Assistant: Courtney Hesslein
Business Manager: Shirley Yang

Facilities Staff:
Patricia Cartagena-Perez
Frank Hickey
Paul Lacy
Felix Pena

Putterham
Branch Supervisor
Batia Blumenthal

Brookline Village
Head of Collection
Services
Ryan Brennan

Brookline Village
Head of Circulation
Sarah Durkin

Brookline Village
Head of Reference
Vacant

Brookline Village
Head of Youth
Services
Julie Kelindorfer

Coolidge Corner
Branch Supervisor
Guy Harris

Putterham
Staff

LA III - Sebastian
Sulser
LA II - Charlotte Ryan
PT Lib - VACANT
PT LA: Jackie Corcoran
PT LA: Rosa Nicolazzo
PT LA: Dora Sourafis
PT Page: Jessica Becker

Collection Services
Staff

Lib II - Tiffany Wilson
Lib I - Jinting Long
LA II - Shirley
Poon-Cho
LA II - Percival Salazar

Circulation
Staff

LA II - Roberta Blumenthal
LA II - Roberto
Lauro-Priestly
LA II - Sarah Collier
LA II - Celia Dennis
PT LA: Karen O'Keefe
PT LA: Adrian Ortega
PT LA: Kevin Tang
PT LA: Mac Miller
PT Page: Kaelan Heston
PT Page: Lily
Perrella-Lewellen

Reference
Staff

Lib II - Lilian Weitzman
Lib II - Jess Steytler
Lib I - Bryan Kreusch
Lib I - Ginger O'Day
Lib I - Jared Walske
Lib I - Nina Rabkina

Youth Services
Staff

Lib II - Robin Brenner
Lib I - Abbey Stephens
Lib I - Macy Davis
LA III - Amy Diamond
LA III - Sasha
Zeidenberg
PT LA: Silvia Lee
PT LA: Emma Heuchert
PT LA: Zitong Yi
PT LA: VACANT
PT LA: Maryanne
Shaughnessy
PT LA: Carrie
Zuttermeister
PT Page: Ariel Ervin
PT Page: Madinah Bond

Coolidge Corner
Staff

Lib II - Brita Zitin
Lib II - Caroline
Richardson
Lib II - Elissa Martel
LA II - Brenda Craig
LA II - Jeanne Val
LA II - Kenny Yim
PT Lib: Jackie Bateman
PT LA: Khara Marsh
PT LA: Catherine Saines
PT LA: VACANT
PT LA: Jackson
Mathews
PT LA: Ji Baek
PT LA: Lauren Hegedus
PT Page: Winnie Huie
PT Page: Tom Golden
PT Page: James Yee
PT Page: River Tiech
PT Page: Connor Pahl



THE PUBLIC LIBRARY OF BROOKLINE

Where stories begin.

The Board of Library Trustees

Meeting: Library Trustees

Date: Tuesday, July 11, 2023

Time: 6:15 PM - 8:15 PM

Location: Hybrid

In-person: Trustees Room, Public Library of Brookline, 361 Washington Street, 02445

Zoom Registration:

- <https://brooklinema.zoomgov.com/j/1610477762?pwd=MzZpOFgwTGkwQVlzNGFsRVVCYVUzZz09>
- **Passcode: w45dmxQu**

- I. Comments from the Chair
- II. Comments from the Public (5 minute limit)
- III. Secretary's Report
 - A. Minutes
 - B. Correspondence
 - C. Other items
- IV. Treasurer's Report
 - A. Other
- V. Library Director's Report
 - A. Statistical
 - B. Financial
- VI. Trustee Committee Reports
 - A. Other
- VII. Old Business
 - A.



THE PUBLIC LIBRARY OF BROOKLINE

Where stories begin.

VIII. New Business

A. Fine Free Banners

B. 3% Wage Increase for Part-time Non-Union Staff

IX. Remarks for the Good of the Order

X. Adjourn

If you plan to make a motion or amend the minutes, please give a written copy to the Trustee Secretary.

Please see link to documents relevant to this meeting:

<https://www.brooklinema.gov/DocumentCenter/Index/1826>

Please contact Library Administration (brkadmin@minlib.net / 617-730-2360) with questions about this meeting.

The Public Library of Brookline

Trustees Report June 2023

MLN top-five print circulation **(all branches)**

Cambridge: 111,095 (+3.05%)

Newton: 105,143 (+15.61%)

Brookline: 70,367 (+5.55%)

Arlington: 63,303 (-9.67%)

Lexington: 61,613 (+0.87%)

BRK branch print circulation

Brookline Village: 33,553 (+4.27%)

Coolidge Corner: 24,113 (+5.21%)

Putterham: 12,701 (+9.79%)

Total: 70,367 (+5.55%)

BRK print + digital circulation

OverDrive: 19,125 (+13.93%)

Hoopla: 3,254 (-23.24%)

Kanopy: 1,256 (-10.48%)

Print: 70,367 (+5.55%)

Total: 94,002 (+5.51%)

Turnover

Brookline Village: 2.46 (+43.86%)

Coolidge Corner: 3.72 (-40.10%)

Putterham: 3.78 (+37.45%)

New Library Cards

Brookline Village: 230

Coolidge Corner: 183

Putterham: 70

Attendance

Brookline Village: 24,604

(+37.06%)

Coolidge Corner: 13,381 (+4.06%)

Putterham: 4,390 (-0.16%)

Total: 42,375 (+20.59%)

Computer sessions (all **locations)**

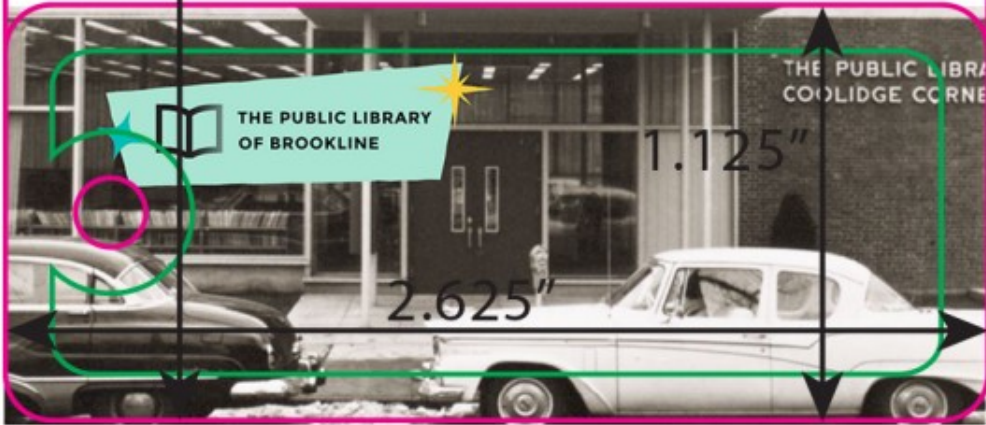
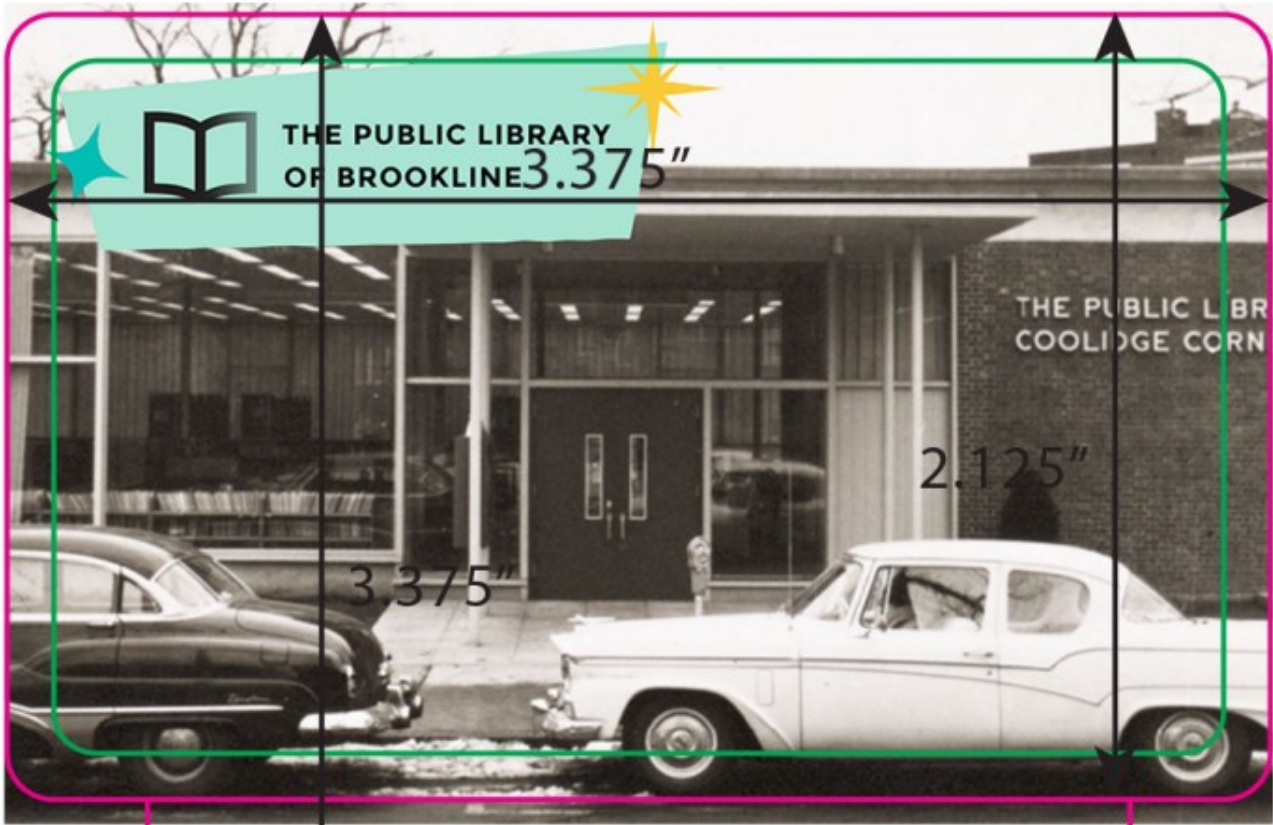
Desktop (Useful/Chromebox): n/a

Wifi: n/a

Pages printed: n/a

Title of Motion: Convening of the Meeting 6:24 pm

Trustee	Yay	Nay	Abstain	Absent
Burstein				x
Chanyasulkit				x
Fredkin				x
Goleman	x			
Hung	x			
Livingston				x
Lohe	x			
Margolis	x			
Martin-Page	x			
Vanderkay	x			
Vogt	x			
Zelka	x			



Director's Report

July, 2023

Meeting Stakeholders & Government Relations

I made two presentations this month, one to the BrooklineCan group and the other to the Council on Aging which highlighted the library's goals as well as programs and services of interest to seniors.

Conference Attendance

I attended the American Library Association Conference in Chicago from June 22nd - 26th. I saw many interesting presentations, of note:

- Security in Today's Libraries
- Edible Science - STEM based food programming
- Importance of Outreach and Meeting Folx Where They Are
- Book Rich Environments - A model for approaching partnerships with local housing authorities to get people reading
- Expanding the Diversity Umbrella

Fine Free

PLB is now fine free! Information appeared in the newsletter, a press release is being crafted, and we have an interview lined up with Brookline.news

New Library Card Design

Every year the library purchases library cards in bulk. In the past it has had the Minuteman Library Network design. This year, Library Administration decided to implement a new card design and will continue to do so every year. We used a vintage photo of the Coolidge Corner Library along with a logo that Robin Brenner designed. Due to the tight turnaround, this card was staff designed but it may be fun to invite the public to submit designs in future years.

New Database:

The PLB has added the resource LinkedIn Learning! *LinkedIn Learning is an online educational platform that helps you discover and develop business, technology-related, and creative skills through expert-led course videos.*

With more than 5,000 courses and personalized recommendations, you can discover, complete, and track courses related to your field and interests. You can also choose to add these courses and related skills to your LinkedIn profile once you've completed them.

Aside from being a fantastic resource for patrons, it can be used as a staff development and training tool.

ARPA / Bookmobile

Nothing to report

Budget

FY23: Please see budget documents in the Director's Report File Folder

FY24: first month of fiscal year, nothing to report

Personnel

See Position Control and Org Chart Documents in the Director's Report File Folder

Resignations: Dahlia Balthazar (PT Library Assistant - CC)

New Hires and Promotions:

- Sasha Zeidenberg (Library Assistant III - YS)

Patriot Act

The library has not been served with any court orders since the last meeting.

Minutes of the Board of Library Trustees, Public Library of Brookline

A virtual meeting of the Trustees of the Public Library was convened on Tuesday, June 13, 2023, at 6:24 PM.

Present: Goleman, Hung, Livingston, Lohe, Margolis, Martin-Page, Vanderkay, Vogt, Zelkha.

Absent: Burstein, Chanyasulkit, Fredkin

Trustees voted to convene the meeting.

Also present: Library Director, A. Hirst; Assistant Director to Administration, D. Savin, Julie KelIndorfer (YS Supervisor), Sarah Durkin (Circulation Supervisor), Batia Bloomenthal (Putterham Supervisor)

All votes were conducted by roll call vote.

- I. Comments from the Chair.
 - A. Margolis is acting chair for the meeting
 - B. Margolis at the last meeting had taken the stance that libraries should be neutral. He considered Goleman's response of neutral can be a position, and would like to state non-partisan may be a more accurate term.
 - C. Hirst introduces Sarah Durkin as the Library's new Circulation Supervisor. She is excited to be a part of the library community.
- II. Comments from the Public (5 minute limit)
 - A. No comments
- III. Batia Bloomenthal Presents a Summary of the Puuterham's Accessibility Kits for Neurodiverse Patrons
 - A. Hirst introduces Batia Bloomenthal to address FY23 year long action items of creating accessibility kits for neurodiverse patrons. A staff member recommended this as a way to welcome and help neurodiverse patrons feel comfortable at the library. This was narrowed down to children and adult patrons who are neurodiverse and/or have sensory sensitivities.
 - B. Putterham challenges: Noise carries easily, too bright in the day, no private study areas.
 - C. Research shows tools used to control environments reduce anxiety in neurodiverse patrons and can also assist in social interactions.
 - D. Nov 2022, Grant use with YS staff, to add to all three locations, Godine fund

- E. 2 Circulating kits at Putterham. 1 for library use, 1 for home use. Once use has been shown to be helpful, the Library would like to have more at each branch. \$1141.08 on kits
- F. The kits provide: Noise reducing headphones, light sensitivity glasses, fidget toy, pin art set, weighted lap pad, tactile cushion, tactile brush, bubble wrap toy, sensory desk toy, kick bags.
- G. Thanks to Putterham staff, YS staff, tech services staff, and Bernice Godine Fund
- H. Margolis would like to thank Batia for her work at the Library, as she will be leaving in August. Batia thanks everyone for the opportunities she has had at the Library.

IV. Julie Kellndorfer presents on Summer Reading

- A. Theme this year is Find Your Voice. Why summer reading: Encourages reading as a lifelong habit, incentives reluctant readers, prevents “summer reading loss”, reinforces reading for fun, boosts library attendance and community engagement.
- B. Last year stats: 2322 spins on wheels, 5907 hours of reading, 21 programs, 1231 attendees, 844 people registered
- C. Goals: Celebrate reading, increase use of libraries, engage with the Brookline community.
- D. Kids: 0-9 have the reading goal of 20 hours, while earning spins on the prize wheel. Tweens, teens and adults: no sign up needed, spin the wheel for checking out an item, limit one person per day.
- E. Dates: Program starts June 20th, ends August 19th, as well as various events available for details on the Library calendar.
- F. Budget: Total of \$9500 spent from the Trustees and the Friends.
- G. Hirst explains part of the outreach is teaming up with Brookline Public Schools, who serve meals to those who are food insecure, providing free books to people who pick up meals and join at their kick off event.

V. Secretary's Report

- A. Martin-Page asks that the minutes from the May meeting be approved.
 - 1. Motion: Lohe makes a motion to approve all the minutes. It passes.
- B. There was correspondence from the Rockland Trust
- C. Hirst and some of the Trustees received letters regarding the Black Lives Matter and Prides flags outside the Library locations, arguing for them to be taken down.

VI. Treasurer's Report

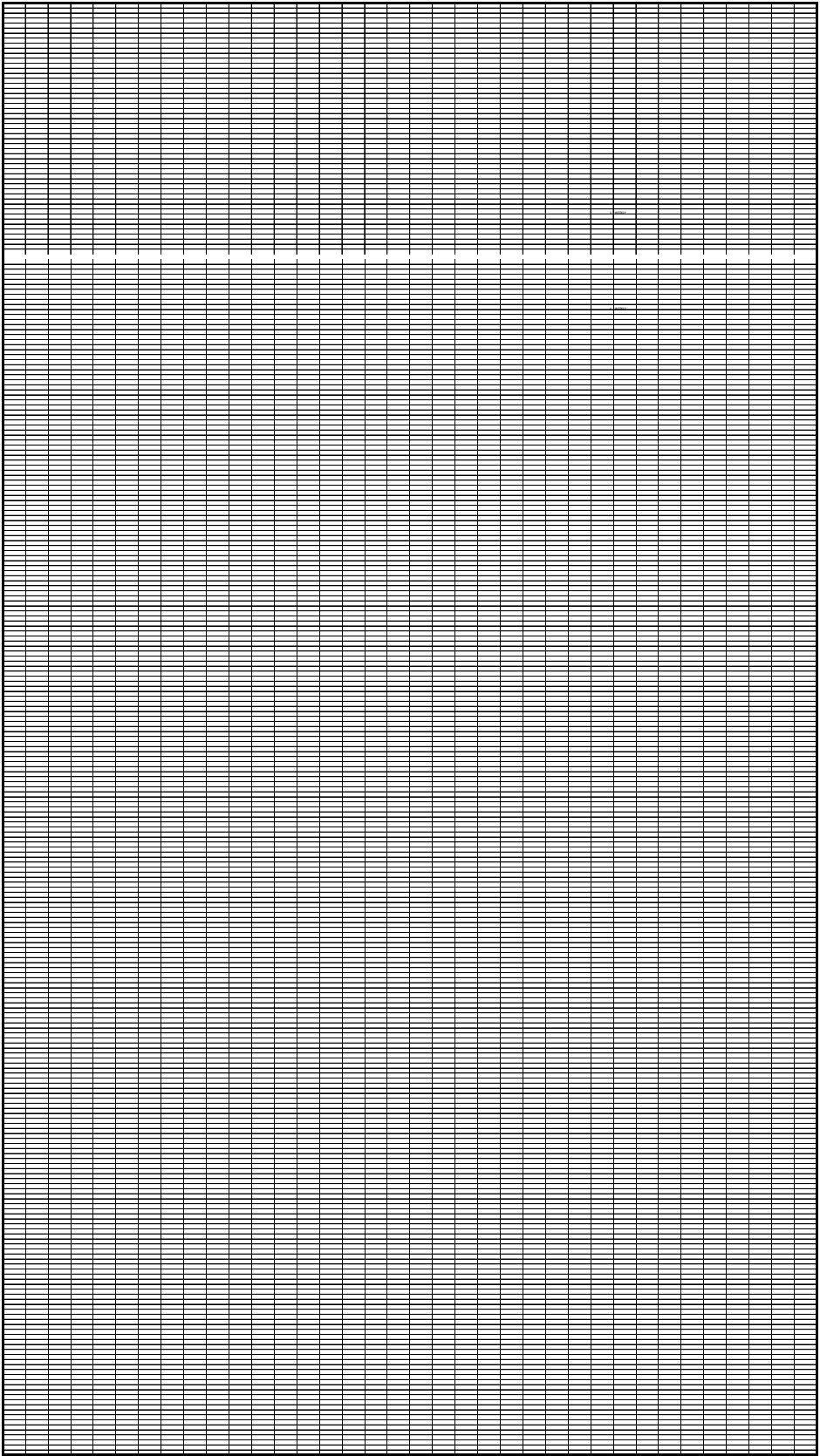
- A. Lohe gives report

VII. Library Director's Report

- A. Savin presents stats: There was difficulty collecting circulation stats because the servers were being upgraded.
- B. Digital lending went down as Hoopla loans have dropped, as have Kanopy, but not as drastically. The Library has included a new limit for the amount of Hoopla uses per month, which has affected stats. Overdrive is still popular. See Documents for details.
- C. On budget for this year, the Library had extra money for utilities. This has been used for fixing the curtains in Hunneman Hall, buying new desks for YS staff, and buying appropriately sized furniture for The Rabbit Hole.
- D. New Hires: Sarah Durkin (the Circulation Supervisor), Courtney Hesslein (Executive Assistant to the Director), as well as internal promotions, including Jingting Long and Elissa Martel. PT LA Jackson Matthews will be working out of class full time in the Reference Department. Amanda Hirst will temporarily serve as Reference Supervisor.
- E. Resignations: Roy MacKenzie will be leaving the Library after 10 years of service in June, Batia Bloomenthal will be leaving after 24 years at the Library in August. Both positions are under recruitment.
- F. The garden has been planted out front of the library for the Pollinator's Path
- G. Public art project- Turkeys around town. Hirst met with organizers, who would like to place a turkey near each of the Library Branches.
- H. Martin-Page (?) makes a motion to approve the placement of the Turkeys near each of the branches. The motion passes unanimously.
- I. Lohe questions library turnover. Hirst says compensation is a factor, as well as lifestyle choices and wanting changes in their careers.
- J. Hiring challenges: interview before position closes as many applicants are accepting other job offers, more applicants from private sectors, and people who want a job that aligns with their values.
- K. Margolis acknowledges Dr. Carter's report. Hirst explains Zoom sessions for staff have been scheduled in July to go over the report as well as sessions for Boards.
- L. Hirst is planning on buying an Automated Materials Handling System that will help sort materials when returned.
- M. M. X moves to approve buying sorting technology. It passes.
- N. M: Margolis moves to adjourn the meeting. It passes unanimously.

Meeting adjourned at 7:54 pm.

Minutes drafted by Carrie Zuttermeister





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